

FOSS Bytes



Moblin + Maemo = MeeGo

Intel and Nokia are merging their Moblin and Maemo software platforms to create MeeGo, a Linux-based software platform that will support multiple hardware architectures across a wide range of device segments, including pocketable mobile computers, netbooks, tablets, media phones, connected TVs and in-vehicle infotainment systems. The platform is expected to accelerate time-to-market for a range of new Internet-based applications and services, besides exciting user experiences. MeeGo-based devices from Nokia and other manufacturers are expected to be launched later this year.

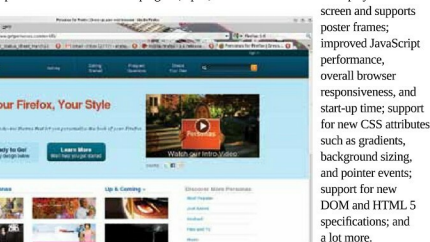
MeeGo builds on the capabilities of the Moblin core OS and its support for a wide range of device types and reference user experiences, combined with the momentum of Maemo in the mobile industry and the broadly adopted Qt application and UI framework for software developers.

MeeGo also unites the worldwide Maemo and Moblin applications ecosystems and open source communities. For developers, MeeGo extends the range of target device segments for their applications. Using Qt for application development means that they can write applications once and easily deploy them on MeeGo and across other platforms, like Symbian, for example. Developers can begin writing applications for MeeGo in Qt immediately. The first release of MeeGo is targeted for the second quarter of this year. Keep an eye on meego.com, hosted by the Linux Foundation, for updates.

Have you updated to Firefox 3.6 yet?

Mozilla delivered Firefox 3.6 on January 21, 2010, powered by an updated rendering engine, Gecko 1.9.2. The latest version promises "...many improvements for Web developers, add-on developers, and users. This version is also faster and more responsive than previous versions and has been optimised to run on small device operating systems such as Maemo."

The release notes [www.mozilla-europe.org/en/firefox/3.6/releasesnotes] indicate the following important feature additions: support for a new type of theme called Personas;



'We're Linux' returns for the second year in a row

The Linux Foundation has announced the second 'We're Linux' video contest. The theme of the video contest is to demonstrate what Linux means to you and to inspire others to try it. According to the announcement, "The contest is calling all community members and amateur filmmakers to share with the public what a 30-60 second Linux-focused spot for the Super Bowl might look like."

The last date for submission of videos is on April 4, 2010. The winners are going to be announced at this year's 4th annual Linux Foundation Collaboration Summit. The prize is a Linux-powered laptop and a free trip to this year's LinuxCon, scheduled for August 10-12, 2010, at Boston.

Faster start-up times with OpenOffice.org 3.2

The OpenOffice.org Community has released a new version of its office productivity suite—version 3.2. The new or improved features include: faster start-up times; improved compatibility with open standard (ODF) and proprietary file formats; improvements to all components, particularly the Calc spreadsheet, with over a dozen new or enhanced features; the Chart module (usable throughout OpenOffice.org) that has had a usability makeover and offers new chart types; and many more.

Florian Effenberger, marketing project lead of OpenOffice.org, explains: "Some people are currently locked in to other personal productivity tools—maybe by corporate IT policy, or by a tie-in to other legacy software. For everyone else, we want OpenOffice.org to be the 2010 office software of choice, and 3.2 takes us another step towards that goal."